

D630

Designing Curriculum and Instruction I

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A grade-level team in a district with a new superintendent is designing a unit on ecosystems. One teacher has a favorite terrarium activity she has used for ten years. Following backward design, what should the team do first?

- A. Write the unit test.
- B. Identify the understandings and standards students should master.
- C. Plan the terrarium activity, since it is proven.
- D. Choose a textbook chapter on ecosystems.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A curriculum committee at a large K-8 school spends its first two meetings comparing three publishers' reading programs. The school has a new library and 900 students. Following an objectives-first model, what should the committee have done first?

- A. Pick the cheapest program.
- B. Design the evaluation first, then the outcomes.
- C. Survey the library's current collection.
- D. Define the reading outcomes students should achieve.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A science department at a school known for its robotics team is deciding whether seventh-grade physical science will cover only forces and motion or also energy and waves, and how deeply each will be taught. The department chair prefers color-coded plans. Which curriculum element is being decided?

- A. Sequence.
- B. Pacing guide formatting.
- C. Assessment.
- D. Scope.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team decides that students should learn ratios before proportions, and proportions before percent problems. Which curriculum element is this?

- A.** Scope.
- B.** Sequence.
- C.** Horizontal alignment.
- D.** Hidden curriculum.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Fourth-grade teachers in a district with a strong parent association report that incoming students were never taught multi-digit multiplication, though fourth-grade lessons assume it. The district recently switched bus companies. What kind of alignment problem is this?

- A.** Horizontal alignment.
- B.** A pacing problem only within fourth grade.
- C.** A transportation issue.
- D.** Vertical alignment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Two sixth-grade English teachers in the same school use different writing rubrics and cover different genres, so students' experiences depend on their teacher. What alignment fix is needed?

- A.** Horizontal alignment of genres and rubrics across the sixth-grade classes.
- B.** Require identical daily lesson scripts for all teachers.
- C.** Give each teacher full freedom to choose.
- D.** Vertical alignment with fifth and seventh grade.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A K–5 math map shows a standard on telling time taught at the same level in grades 1, 2, and 3, while a standard on elapsed time appears in no grade. The school’s math night drew 200 families. What does the map reveal?

- A. A gap in telling time.
- B. Helpful spiral review of telling time and no problems.
- C. A redundancy in telling time and a gap in elapsed time.
- D. A need for more family math nights.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A map of 40 grade-5 science standards shows 34 taught at least once. How many gaps does the map show?

- A. 34
- B. 74
- C. 6
- D. 0, because most standards are taught.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

The district curriculum guide for high school biology includes a four-week genetics unit. A classroom observer finds that one teacher spends two days on genetics because she is behind schedule. Her class meets in a portable building. Which curriculum concept explains this?

- A. The written (intended) curriculum differs from the taught (enacted) curriculum.
- B. A problem with the portable building.
- C. The hidden curriculum.
- D. The assessed curriculum.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A district evaluating a new writing curriculum wants to know whether teachers are actually using the lessons as planned this year. The district is the largest in its county and recently upgraded its email system. Which part of CIPP does this question address?

- A.** Product.
- B.** Input.
- C.** Process.
- D.** Context.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A district asks whether students' writing scores improved after two years with the new curriculum. Which CIPP component is this?

- A.** Context.
- B.** Product.
- C.** Input.
- D.** Process.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A curriculum team has 48 math standards and time to teach about 30 deeply. The team meets in a newly remodeled conference room. Which approach best guides which standards to prioritize?

- A.** Prioritize standards with lasting value, use across subjects, and importance for the next grade.
- B.** Cut the 18 standards teachers like least.
- C.** Prioritize only standards that appear on every test every year.
- D.** Give all 48 standards equal time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A grade-level team ~~in a district with a new superintendent~~ is designing a unit on ecosystems. One teacher has a favorite terrarium activity ~~she has used for ten years~~. Following backward design, what should the team do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Backward design starts with desired results.

A	Inverted operation	Evidence is Stage 2, after results.
B	Correct	Stage 1 is desired results.
C	Camouflage	Activities come last.
D	Adjacent category	Resource-first planning, not backward design.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A curriculum committee at a large K-8 school spends its first two meetings comparing three publishers' reading programs. ~~The school has a new library and 900 students.~~ Following an objectives-first model, what should the committee have done first?

Target word: correct starting point **Decides:** Purposes must come before materials.

A	Adjacent category	Still starts with materials.
B	Inverted operation	Evaluation follows from purposes.
C	Camouflage	An irrelevant detail as a starting point.
D	Correct	Purposes drive the selection of experiences and materials.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A science department at a school ~~known for its robotics team~~ is deciding whether seventh-grade physical science will cover only forces and motion or also energy and waves, and how deeply each will be taught. ~~The department chair prefers color-coded plans.~~ Which curriculum element is being decided?

Target word: scope or sequence **Decides:** Breadth and depth of content.

A	Confusion set	Sequence is the order of topics.
B	Camouflage	The chair's formatting preference is not the decision.
C	Adjacent category	They are deciding content, not evidence.
D	Correct	Scope is what is covered and how deeply.

4. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A team decides that students should learn ratios before proportions, and proportions before percent problems. Which curriculum element is this?

Target word: classify the decision **Decides:** It sets the order.

A	Inverted operation	Scope is breadth and depth, not order.
B	Correct	The order in which content is taught.
C	Adjacent category	Consistency across classrooms at one level.
D	Confusion set	Unstated lessons, not planned order.

5. Answer D Concept 4

Fourth-grade teachers in a district ~~with a strong parent association~~ report that incoming students were never taught multi-digit multiplication, though fourth-grade lessons assume it. ~~The district recently switched bus companies.~~ What kind of alignment problem is this?

Target word: vertical or horizontal **Decides:** A disconnect between grade levels.

A	Confusion set	Horizontal is across classrooms within a grade.
B	Adjacent category	The gap began in the earlier grade.
C	Camouflage	The bus change is irrelevant.
D	Correct	Learning does not build properly from one grade to the next.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

Two sixth-grade English teachers in the same school use different writing rubrics and cover different genres, so students' experiences depend on their teacher. What alignment fix is needed?

Target word: reverse: same grade, different classes **Decides:** Inconsistency within one grade.

A	Correct	Same grade, different classrooms.
B	Absolute language	Alignment means shared outcomes and criteria, not scripts.
C	Dropped element	Keeps the inconsistency.
D	Inverted operation	Addresses across-grade flow, not within-grade consistency.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A K-5 math map shows a standard on telling time taught at the same level in grades 1, 2, and 3, while a standard on elapsed time appears in no grade. ~~The school's math night drew 200 families.~~ What does the map reveal?

Target word: read the map **Decides:** Repeats at the same level and a missing standard.

A	Inverted operation	Telling time is over-covered, not missing.
B	Confusion set	Spiraling increases depth; same-level repeats are redundancy, and the gap remains.
C	Correct	Same-level repetition is redundancy; an untaught standard is a gap.
D	Camouflage	Attendance is not what the map shows.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A map of 40 grade-5 science standards shows 34 taught at least once. How many gaps does the map show?

Target word: count gaps **Decides:** Gaps = standards not taught.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the number taught.
B	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting.
C	Correct	$40 - 34 = 6$ standards never taught.
D	Absolute language	Any untaught standard is a gap.

9. Answer A Concept 6

The district curriculum guide for high school biology includes a four-week genetics unit. A classroom observer finds that one teacher spends two days on genetics because she is behind schedule. ~~Her class meets in a portable building.~~ Which curriculum concept explains this?

Target word: intended vs. enacted **Decides:** What is written differs from what is taught.

A	Correct	The guide's four weeks became two days in practice.
B	Camouflage	The room is irrelevant.
C	Confusion set	Hidden curriculum is unstated norms, not a shortened unit.
D	Adjacent category	Nothing here concerns what is tested.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A district evaluating a new writing curriculum wants to know whether teachers are actually using the lessons as planned this year. ~~The district is the largest in its county and recently upgraded its email system.~~ Which part of CIPP does this question address?

Target word: classify the evaluation question **Decides:** It asks about implementation.

A	Confusion set	Product is outcomes.
B	Confusion set	Input is plans and resources before use.
C	Correct	Process evaluation examines implementation.
D	Adjacent category	Context is needs and setting.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

A district asks whether students' writing scores improved after two years with the new curriculum. Which CIPP component is this?

Target word: classify the evaluation question **Decides:** It asks about outcomes.

A	Confusion set	Context examines needs.
B	Correct	Product evaluation examines outcomes.
C	Adjacent category	Input judges plans and resources.
D	Inverted operation	Process looks at implementation.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A curriculum team has 48 math standards and time to teach about 30 deeply. ~~The team meets in a newly remodeled conference room.~~ Which approach best guides which standards to prioritize?

Target word: prioritization criteria **Decides:** Too many standards for the time.

A	Correct	Endurance, leverage, and readiness guide priority.
B	Adjacent category	Preference is not a curriculum criterion.
C	Absolute language	Test frequency is one input, not the only criterion.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the time limit and priority.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Backward design order	Identify desired results, then decide acceptable evidence, then plan learning activities.	Starting with favorite activities or the textbook.	A planning sequence to put in order.
2	Tyler's objectives-first rationale	Curriculum design starts with clear purposes; learning experiences, organization, and evaluation all follow from them.	Choosing materials before defining purposes.	A committee debating resources before goals.
3	Scope vs. sequence	Scope is the breadth and depth of what is taught; sequence is the order in which it is taught.	Using the two terms interchangeably.	"What" and "how much" vs. "in what order."
4	Vertical vs. horizontal alignment	Vertical alignment connects learning across grade levels; horizontal alignment keeps the same grade or course consistent across classrooms and subjects.	Calling any alignment problem vertical.	Across grades vs. across teachers in one grade.
5	Curriculum mapping for gaps and redundancy	A map shows standards never taught (gaps) and content taught repeatedly at the same level (redundancy).	Treating repeated content as always helpful spiral review.	A standards-by-grade map with blanks or repeats.
6	Written, taught, and learned curriculum	The written (intended), taught (enacted), and learned curricula can differ; the hidden curriculum is what students learn from unstated norms.	Assuming what is written is what is taught.	A difference between the guide and what happens in class.
7	CIPP evaluation	Context (needs), Input (plans and resources), Process (implementation), and Product (outcomes) evaluate different questions about a curriculum.	Evaluating only outcomes.	An evaluation question to classify.
8	Prioritizing standards	Curriculum analysis prioritizes standards with endurance, leverage across subjects, and readiness for the next level.	Giving every standard equal time.	Too many standards for the time available.

Course scope (public description): Designing Curriculum and Instruction I examines the influence that specific theories, design principles, and evaluation models have on the quality and effectiveness of a curriculum. During the course, candidates will conduct a curriculum analysis in order to determine the content that students need. The course requires candidates to learn how to define the scope and sequence of a curriculum to ensure vertical and horizontal alignment. This course will also teach how to map curriculum to address any gaps or unnecessary duplication within and across grade levels. There are no prerequisites for this course.